

fuRo Bipedal robot

fuRo's latest robotic bipedal robot weighs 230kg, and can lift 100kgs of load

New Phenoms

AMD launched several processors including a high-end 6-core Phenom II X6 1075T

Cover feature

India? The fact remains that almost all of the popular brands have setup shop here. All the popular LCD and Plasma TVs are still available here. LED TVs have only recently entered the market. If you have the money, today, you can buy anything from a 26-inch LCD TV priced at as little as ₹25,000 to something priced at around ₹20,00,000 if you're looking for absolute performance and style.

We've seen through popular searches and questions over the years, that most people look for 32-inch TVs. A lot of people are used to 21-inch CRT TVs, so an upgrade to a 32-inch LCD TV seems like light years ahead, and they're right.

What about the popularity of the different technologies of TVs? LCD TVs have been the most popular of all the terms used on Google. LED TVs have only recently picked up and are as popular as Plasma TVs. Many more people are looking for 32-inch TVs over 42-inch and 26-inch TVs. Clearly, budget is a concern. The only confusing bit about 32-inch LCD TVs is the two options available. A few years ago, the only option was to go for a 768p (1366x768) 32-inch TV, while 42-inch TVs had full HD resolutions (1920x1080). Recently however, full 1080p resolution has arrived on the smaller 32-inch format. 1080p is more popular than ever before now. Market prices of these 32-inch full HD TVs start from around ₹27,000.

What are people looking for?

Having bought and used CRT TVs for real long periods of time, most of them have got the money's worth. CRT TVs have run for close to 10 years or more in some cases without any problem. They were also a lot cheaper than LCD TVs. CRT TVs are still available but for a fraction of price of popular LCD and Plasma TVs. Spending power has improved dramatically and people are fine with spending more and settling for a cheap LCD TV. The largest number of buyers seems to be in the sub-₹30,000 range with either a 26-inch or 32-inch TV in mind.

CATEGORIES: 32-inch TVs

If you're buying a 32-inch TV, you will be spending at least ₹23,000 on it. That's a lot of money, and it makes sense

to spend a little more and purchase a TV that can handle 1080i/p resolutions. Last year, around this time, 32-inch TV were priced at a minimum of around ₹32,000. This included TVs from brands such as Philips, Hitachi and Panasonic. Full HD (1080p) sets on the other hand were still close to ₹40,000. Brands such as Sony were still priced higher. Their 768p TVs were close to ₹38,000 and the full HD 32-inch TVs around ₹42,000.

Today, 768p TVs are available for around ₹23,000 – that's close to a 40 per cent drop! Similarly, 32-inch 1080p TVs too have dropped drastically. The additional benefit is the festival season which means you will see good discounts or freebies being given away with them.

42-inch TVs

42-inch TV prices too have plummeted but not as much as the 32-inchers. Prices start from around ₹40,000, and have dropped by around 15 to 20 per cent. Prices might drop even further during Diwali. If they do touch the ₹35,000 mark this Diwali, grab the opportunity. Features such as 200Hz refresh rate might not be available, but then again, as we've said before, they don't really matter that much to most people.

TO BUY, OR NOT TO BUY?

The market is bubbling with activity. Almost every popular manufacturer such as LG, Samsung and Sony are going ga-ga over LED TVs. Market prices of most



Samsung's brand new Series 9000 LED TV



LG 47LG50HR - the 47-inch giant

32-inch LED-backlit TVs start at around ₹40,000. The slimmer TVs can go up to ₹60,000 even for 32-inch TVs. Malls are not the cheapest places to buy LCD TVs, from what we've discovered. Look for other retail showrooms and shops which sell TVs and other home appliances. You can actually get TVs for up to 10 to 15 per cent cheaper there.

If you're looking for a good 32-inch TV, then you should spend time investigating Sony's KLV-32NX500 priced at ₹42,500. It was one of the best performers in our last LCD TV test. Prices have dropped a lot since then, and it makes even more sense to buy it now.

LG's Jazz (42LG80FR) is a slightly older model but apart from good colour reproduction and fancy design, you also get a pair of excellent sliding speakers. If you're thinking of something larger – something in the 47-inch category, the LG 47LG50HR should grab your attention. The price for this model is around ₹48,000 in the market.



CAMERA CONFUSION

Panasonic DMC – TZ10 or Sony DSC – TX5? Canon 550D or Nikon D3000? DSLR or Prosumer? 10 MP or 15 MP? 3X optical zoom or 12 X optical zoom? Touchscreen or buttons? These are just some of the questions you might come across when looking at cameras.

Be Sure

Digital cameras are divided into three main segments, the point and shoot; ultrazooms and DSLRs. But now-a-days, with ultrazooms also coming in a compact form factor, the lines between